

WEREWOLF

Facilitator Guide — how to run the class game

28 players · ages 12–14 · 45–60 minutes · you are the moderator, never a player

1 • The game in 30 seconds

Werewolf (also called Mafia) is a secret-roles deduction game. A few students are secretly Werewolves picking off villagers; everyone else tries to unmask them through argument and voting. You never play — you narrate the night, run the debate, and count the votes.

- **Hidden roles.** The class is a village. Of your 28 students, 3 are secretly Werewolves, 1 is a Detective, 1 is a Doctor, and 23 are ordinary Villagers. Only the wolves know who their pack is.
- **NIGHT — about 90 seconds.** Everyone closes their eyes. You wake each special role one at a time: the wolves silently point at a victim, the detective asks you whether one player is a wolf (silent thumbs signal), the doctor silently protects one player.
- **DAY — about 7 minutes.** Everyone opens their eyes. You announce who died. The village debates for 5 minutes, then votes by secret ballot to eliminate one suspect. The wolves vote too — and lie brilliantly.
- **Winning.** Village wins when the last wolf is voted out. Wolves win when they equal or outnumber the villagers still alive.
- **Pace.** One night + one day is 8–10 minutes. Three to five rounds is a satisfying game.

2 • What you need

Item	Where it comes from	How many
Role cards	werewolf-role-cards.pdf, pages 1–3	28 cards: 3 wolf, 1 detective, 1 doctor, 23 villager
Spares + spectator cards	werewolf-role-cards.pdf, page 4	optional — replacements and 3 spectator cards
Ballot slips	werewolf-props.pdf, page 1	28 per game (one sheet = 12; print 3 sheets)
Accusation slips	werewolf-props.pdf, page 2	28 per day (print 5 sheets for a full game)
Moderator pocket card	werewolf-props.pdf, page 3	1 for you (the sheet has 2 identical copies)
Role reference poster	werewolf-props.pdf, page 4	1, on the board or wall

Also grab: a mug or box for ballots, any object as the “talking stick” (a whiteboard marker works), your phone as a visible timer, and cardstock for the cards if you have it.

3 • Prep — 10 minutes before class

- Cut the 28 role cards, shuffle, and keep the spares in your folder.
- Decide your detective signal and rehearse it once: thumb UP = werewolf, thumb DOWN = innocent. Keep your signalling hand low, near your chest, so a peeking neighbour can't see it.

- Arrange seats so everyone can see everyone (circle or paired rows facing in). Ballot box at the front.
- Deal one card per student face down either as they enter or right after the intro slide. What they do with a role is private — no swapping, no showing.

4 • The one rule of being the moderator

You are the referee and the storyteller — never a player, never a hint-giver, never on anyone's team. Follow the script below word-for-word the first time you run it: it keeps nights tight, keeps your signals consistent, and keeps the game fair. Use the pocket card from the props pack at your desk.

Spectator rule: when a player is eliminated they stay in the room as a silent shadow — they may watch everything but say nothing and react to nothing until the final reveal.

5 • The script — what to say, word for word

When	Say	Then do
Opening	<i>"We are a village, and wolves are hiding among us. Each night they take a victim. Each day we debate and vote on who to banish. Village wins if we vote out every wolf. Wolves win if they survive to match our numbers. I am the moderator — I never play. No talking at night, no peeking. Ready?"</i>	Deal cards face down if you haven't. Show the roles slide (slide 4).
Night falls	<i>"Night falls on the village. Everyone close your eyes, heads down. No peeking, no talking."</i>	Wait 5 seconds. Scan for peekers. Total silence.
Wolves wake	<i>"Werewolves — open your eyes. Look at your pack. Werewolves, point together at one villager to eliminate."</i>	Wait until all wolves point at the same player. Memorise the victim. "Werewolves, close your eyes."
Detective wakes	<i>"Detective, open your eyes. Point at any player."</i>	Silent signal: thumb UP = wolf, thumb DOWN = innocent. "Detective, close your eyes."
Doctor wakes	<i>"Doctor, open your eyes. Point at one player to protect — not the same person twice in a row."</i>	Nod so they know you saw. "Doctor, close your eyes."
Dawn	<i>"Village, open your eyes!"</i>	If the doctor saved the target: "The wolves attacked last night — but the doctor was there. Nobody died." Otherwise: "[Name] was attacked last night. [Name], you are out — take a spectator card, you are a shadow now."
Debate	<i>"One minute of silence to think and look around." ... after 60 seconds: "Five minutes of debate. Only the person holding the talking stick speaks. Every accusation needs a because."</i>	Start the visible 5-minute timer. Pass the stick. Hard-stop at zero.
The vote	<i>"Time. Fill in your ballot: one name, fold it, drop it in the box."</i>	Collect, then count aloud one slip at a time and tally on the board.
Result	<i>Majority: "[Name] is banished. One last sentence — then you're a shadow." Tie: "Tied vote. Nobody dies today. Night falls again."</i>	Eliminated player sits to the side with their spectator card. Check win conditions (below), then start the next night.

6 • Ending the game (always do the reveal)

After every elimination, silently count wolves vs villagers. All wolves gone → village wins. Wolves equal or outnumber villagers → wolves win. Then have everyone open their cards and show who was who — kids need to check their hunches. Finish with applause for the winning side, wolves or village: a clever wolf win deserves the same clap as a clever village win.

7 • Timing plans

Lesson time	Realistic plan	Notes
30 min	One tight game, 3 rounds	Skip the debrief or take 2 questions on the way out
45 min	One game, 4 rounds + debrief	The sweet spot for a first run
60 min	Two games + full debrief	Second game: deal new roles; try the spicy variant

8 • Common problems and fixes

Problem	Fix
The debate drags on	Hard 5-minute cap with a visible timer. When it rings: “Hands on heads — ballot time.”
One confident kid dominates	Only the talking-stick holder speaks. Rotate it deliberately to quiet students.
Shy students never participate	Everyone must hand in one accusation slip per day (no name needed). Ballots are anonymous, so quiet kids vote fearlessly.
The detective announces themselves on day 1	Before round 1, say: “Whoever you are, detective — survive first, reveal later.” If it still happens, let it play out; it’s a lesson in itself.
Wolves coordinate too openly by day	Remind everyone: “Wolves must act like villagers — bluff, deflect, accuse.”
Someone takes a loss personally	Normalize it: the goal is to survive, but losing well is part of the game. Ban jokes aimed at real personal traits. Applause rule helps.
Peeking at night	First offence = public warning. Second = the player sits out the game and spectates.
Eliminated students whisper hints	Spectators are shadows — seat them together against a wall, away from living players.

9 • Debrief — 10 minutes, and the actual learning

This is where the game becomes ILT evidence: evaluating evidence, persuasion, source-checking and group psychology — the students did it, they just called it fun. Pick three questions:

- What actually helped you decide your vote — and what was just noise?
- When the loudest voice won an argument, were they right?
- Did you change your mind mid-day? What changed it?
- Wolves: what was hardest about lying to your friends?
- Detective: when did you sit on information, and why?
- What should the village do differently in the next game?

10 · Variants for game two

- **Spicy wolves.** Swap one villager card for the spare wolf card: 4 wolves, 22 villagers. Accusations fly faster — great for a confident group.
- **Wolf glance.** Once per day, wolves may briefly flash their eyes open to see each other. Adds coordination without speaking.
- **Forced choice.** If the vote ties two days in a row, the village must nominate exactly two players and choose between them. No endless stalling.

Print pack: *werewolf-role-cards.pdf (4 pages) · werewolf-props.pdf (4 pages) · deck: werewolf-ilt.pptx.*

Keep this guide and the moderator pocket card in your hand all lesson.